Unit -1
Grammar and vocabulary

English for Employability

Parts of Speech

Words are divided into different kinds or classes, called Parts of Speech, according to their use; that is, according to the work they do in a sentence.

The parts of speech are eight in number:

1. Noun. 2. Adjective. 3. Pronoun. 4. Verb. 5. Adverb. 6. Preposition. 7. Conjunction. 8. Interjection.

1.Noun

A Noun is a word used as the name of a person, place, or thing.

Akbar was a great King.

Kolkata is on the Hooghly.

The **rose** smells sweet.

The **sun** shines bright.

There are different kinds of nouns:

- A common noun is a general name for any person, place, thing, or idea. It’s not the specific name of someone or something. For example, “dog,” “city,” and “book” are common nouns
  Eg: Seven students travelled to London during their spring break.
- A Proper Noun is the name of some particular person or place.
  Eg: Seven students travelled to London during their spring break.
- A Collective Noun is the name of a number (or collection) of persons or things taken together and spoken of as one whole.
  Eg: The French army was defeated at Waterloo.
- Abstract nouns are words that you can’t see or touch because they represent ideas, feelings, or qualities. They’re like invisible things that help us understand the world around us. Eg: words like love, bravery, and happiness are all abstract nouns because they describe feelings or concepts rather than physical objects.
- Countable and uncountable nouns.

Emphatic pronoun- emphasises the subject (myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself, themselves)
Eg: I did it myself.
Sharon bought the car herself.
Relative pronoun- introduces a clause which adds more information(who, whom, whose, which, that, what, whoever, whatever, whichever)
Eg: This is the car which she bought.
Interrogative pronoun-introduces a question(who, whom, whose, which, what)
Eg: which car did she buy?
Demonstrative pronoun- points to something specific(this, that, these, those)
Eg: she bought this.
Indefinite pronoun-refers to unspecified things or people(one, none, nobody, no one, nothing, some, something, all, few, many, etc)
Eg: I didn't get any.
Reciprocal pronoun-expresses mutual actions or relationship(each other, one another)
Eg: she and I like each other.

2.Pronoun

A pronoun is a word that is used instead of a noun or a noun phrase.
There are many different types of pronouns.

Personal pronoun- represents a person or thing; can be the subject or the object of a verb.(i, we, you, he, she, it, they, me, us, him, her, them.

Eg: Sheila bought the car for me.
They know her.

Possessive pronoun- shows ownership.(mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs)

Eg: The car is mine.
The cat scratched its neck.

Reflexive pronoun- serves as the object of a verb when the subject and the object refer to the same noun.(myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself, themselves)

Eg: I did it to myself.
The cat scratched itself.

3. Adjective

An Adjective is a word used to add something to the meaning of a noun; as,

- He is a **brave** boy.
- There are **twenty** boys in this class.

4.Verb

A Verb is a word used to express an action or state.Verbs can be divided into 3 classes:main verb, helping verbs and modal verbs.

Helping verbs can be used as an independent verb as well as helping verbs.

- Be- is, am, are, was were; have- have, has, had; do- did

Eg: We have a test tomorrow. We have studied for the last test.

Modal verbs are always used as helping verbs;they indicate the tense, mood or voice(will would, shall, should,can, could, may, might, must, ought).

5.Adverb

Adverbs are used to modify verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs. They add meaning to the word they modify.

Adverb type	Tells us	Examples
Manner	**How** something happens	She came in quickly
frequency	**How often** something happens	He goes to the market daily
Time	**When** something happens	Students have a farewell party today.
Place	**Where** something happens	He wants us to wait outside his room.
Degree	**The intensity or degree** of something	The new shop is too far.

6.Prepositions

A Preposition is a word used with a noun or a pronoun to show how the person or thing denoted by the noun or pronoun stands in relation to something else.

- *Prepositions which indicate time:*

At, on, in, by, after, before, for, since, until, etc

- Prepositions which indicate place or direction:

By, in, on, out, to, from, up, within, beside, between, etc.

- Phrasal prepositions:(more than one word)

Due to, owing to, on account of, because of, according to, etc.

7.Conjunction

A Conjunction is a word used to join words or sentences; as,

Rama **and** Hari are cousins.

I ran fast, **but** missed the train.

Coordinating conjunctions

for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so

Correlative conjunctions

both/and, either/or, neither/nor, not only/but, whether/or

Subordinating conjunctions

after, although, as, as if, as long as, as much as, as soon as, as though, because, before, by the time, even if, even though, if, in order that, in case, in the event that, lest, now that, once, only, only if, provided that, since, so, supposing, that, than, though, till, unless, until, when, whenever, where, whereas, wherever, whether or not, while

8.Interjection

An Interjection is a word which expresses some sudden feeling; as,

- Hurrah! We have won the game.
- Alas! She is dead.

Identify the parts of speech of the words in the following sentences:

- He quickly ran to the store because he forgot his keys.
- The children played happily in the park yesterday.
- I will always remember this special day.
- Despite the heavy rain, we decided to continue our journey.

Correct the following sentences:

1. I work quickly and careful.
2. Him and me went to the store.
3. The book are on the table.
4. She don't like to swim.
5. I seen him yesterday.
6. Between you and I, it's a secret.
7. I have went to the store yesterday.
8. We didn't went to the party.
9. He be tired after work.
10. She done her homework.

Tenses

Tenses

Simple Past Tense (V2) (Did/didn’t +V1)

The Simple Past is used to indicate an action completed in the past.

- I **received** his letter a week ago.
- I **didn't sleep** well.
- Where **did** you **go** last week?

Past Continuous Tense (was/were+ V1+ing)

The Past Continuous is used to denote an action going on at some time in the past.

- We **were watching** TV all evening.
- I **was reading** a book when you called.

Past Perfect Tense (had+v3)

The Past Perfect describes an action completed before a certain moment in the past; If two actions happened in the past, it may be necessary to show which action happened earlier than the other. The Past Perfect is mainly used in such situations. The Simple Past is used in one clause and the Past Perfect in the other.

- I **had written** the letter before he arrived.
- By the time we arrived, they **had already left**.

Past Perfect Continuous Tense (had+been+V1+ing)

The Past Perfect Continuous is used for an action that had been happening over a period of time leading up to another past event or past point of time.

- She **had been studying** for hours when I called her.
- We **had been walking** for miles before we found a place to rest.

Simple Present Tense (V1)

The Simple Present is used to express a habitual action or to express general truths.

- I **get** up every day at five o'clock.
- Honey **is** sweet.

Present Continuous Tense (am/is/are +V1+ing)

For an action going on at the time of speaking for a temporary action which may not be actually happening at the time of speaking

- I **am reading** ‘David Copperfield’. (but I am not reading at this moment).
- He **is cooking** lunch for his family.

Present Perfect Tense (has/have+v3)

The Present Perfect is used to indicate completed activities in the immediate past (with just) or to describe past events when we think more of their effect in the present than of the action itself

- He **has** just **gone** out
- I **have cut** my finger (and it is bleeding now).

Present Perfect Continuous Tense (has/have+been+V1+ing)

The Present Perfect Continuous is used for an action which began at some time in the past and is still continuing

- He **has been sleeping** for five hours
- We **have been waiting** for the bus since 3 o'clock.

Simple future tense (shall/will+V1)

The Simple Future Tense is used to talk about things which we cannot control. It expresses the future as fact.

- I **shall be** twenty next Saturday.
- It **will be** Diwali in a week.

Future Continuous Tense

We use the Future Continuous Tense to talk about actions which will be in progress at a time in the future

- I suppose it **will be raining** when we start.
- This time tomorrow I **will be sitting** on the beach in Singapore

Future Perfect Tense

The Future Perfect Tense is used to talk about actions that will be completed by a certain future time.

- He **will have left** before you go to see him.
- By the end of this month I **will have worked** here for five years

Future Perfect Continuous Tense

The Future Perfect Continuous tense is used for actions which will be in progress over a period of time that will end in the future.

- By next March we **shall have been living** here for four years.
- I **will have been teaching** for twenty years next July.

Tenses

Tense	Past	Present	Future
Simple	wrote	write/writes	Will write
Continuous	was/ were writing	is/am/are writing	Will be writing
Perfect	Had written	has/have written	Will have written
Perfect continuous	Had been writing	has/have been writing	Will have been writing

Exercise

I _____ (work) every day from 9 AM to 5 PM.
She _____ (study) for her final exams right now.
She ___ (visit) her grandmother last weekend.
I ___ (go) to the beach tomorrow.
They ___ (play) football when it started raining.
We ___ (know) each other for five years.
By next year, I ___ (graduate) from college.
He ___ (work) here for three years before he left last month.

Direct and Indirect Speech

Direct Speech: We repeat the speaker words without making any grammatical changes. In writing, we use quotation marks(“...”) to show direct speech. Direct speech is also known as quoted speech.

Indirect speech: We report the speaker’s words without using quotation marks. In indirect speech, we report what someone has said using an introductory reporting verb (‘asked’, ‘replied’ etc.) and a reported clause.In reported speech, the actual words of the original speaker are usually changed.

Notice the changes in pronouns (you-he and I-he); time and place indicators (tomorrow=the next day); and tenses (are going=was going).

Time and place markers

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
this	that
these	those
here	there
now	then
ago	before
today	That day
tonight	That night
tomorrow	The next day

yesterday	The previous day
Last night	The night before
Next week	The following week

Tenses

I am thirsty - he said he was thirsty	Simple present - Simple past
I am going abroad - he said he was going abroad.	Present continuous - past continuous
I have given it - He said he had given it	Present perfect -past perfect
I came out - She said he had come out	Simple past - Past perfect
I was running - She said she had been running	Past continuous - Past perfect continuous
I had seen him - she said she had seen him	Past perfect - no change
I will eat - She said she would eat	Simple future - future Modal verb is changed
I will be studying - She said she would be studying.	Future continuous - future continuous Modal verb is changed eg: will - would
I will have gone - She said she would have gone	Future perfect - future perfect Modal verb is changed

Note

If the reporting verb (said, told) is in the past, present tense become past tense in the reporting clause.

Example : ***He said, "I don't know anybody."***

He said that he didn't know anybody.

But there is **no change of tense** in **the reporting clause** when:

- The reporting verb is in the present tense.

Example: ***She says, "I work here."***

She says that she works here.

- The reporting part is a universal truth/fact/a habitual action.

Example: ***The teacher said, "The sun rises in the east."***

The teacher said that the sun rises in the east.

Types of sentence

We can use sentences for four main purposes in communication:

1. To make a statement - Assertive
   Eg: Suchitra is cleaning her room
2. To ask a question - interrogative
   Eg: Is that car breaking the speed limit?
3. To give an order or make a request -imperative
   Eg: Don’t drive so fast.
4. To make an exclamation - exclamatory
   Eg: how fast that car is travelling!

Reporting a statement (Sub+verb)

Direct:Yasoda **said to** Krishna, “You are mischievous.”

Indirect: Yasoda **told** Krishna **that** he was mischievous.

Reporting a question

All direct questions are changed into statements.
There are two types of questions - **yes/no questions and wh-word questions.**

- When Wh- word questions are reported, the question words are reported as connector.

  Direct : Mother said to son, “when will you have your breakfast?”
  Indirect: Mother asked her son **when** he would have his breakfast.

- When yes/no type of questions are reported, if/ whether are used as connectors

Direct: Raj said to his friend, “Have you seen my keys?”
Indirect: Raj asked his friend **if** he had seen his keys.

Reporting Imperatives

For turning an imperative sentence into an indirect speech, reporting verbs like ask, tell, advise, order, invite, warn, offer promise, request, etc should be used used in the sentence.

All the **verbs** are changed into **infinitives**(to+V1)

DS: He said to the servant, “close the door.”
IS :He asked the servant to close the door.

When **let** expresses a proposal or suggestion, we can use should and change the reporting verb into proposed or suggested.

DS: Sahithi said to her friends, “let’s go for a movie.”
IS: Sahithi suggested her friends that they should go for a movie.

Reporting Exclamations

For turning an exclamatory sentence into an indirect speech, reporting verbs like exclaim, wish, thank, congratulate, etc should be used.

DS: She said, “Alas! I have lost my gold necklace”
IS: She exclaimed with sorrow that she had lost her necklace.

Convert the Following Sentences from Direct to Indirect Speech

1. Direct Speech: "I love ice cream," Sarah said.
   Indirect Speech: _____

2. Direct Speech: "We are going to the beach tomorrow," they told us.
   Indirect Speech: _____

3. Direct Speech: "Can you come to my party?" John asked.
   Indirect Speech: _____

4. Direct Speech: "I have never been to Paris," she mentioned.
   Indirect Speech: _____

5. Direct Speech: "He will call you later," my mom said.
   Indirect Speech: _____

ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICE

- Rishi ate the mango
- The mango was eaten by Ravi

In English grammar, voice describes the relationship between the verb and the subject. When the subject is the doer of the action, the verb is said to be in the active voice. When the subject is the receiver of the action, the verb is said to be in the passive voice.

Passive voice is used when:

- The doer of the action is unknown, irrelevant or implied.

Ex: The thief has been arrested.

- The action or the receiver of the action is more important than the doer of the action or when you don't want to emphasise the subject of the sentence

Ex: She always gets praised by her teachers.

Transformation

1. The object in the active voice sentence becomes the subject in the passive voice sentence.
2. The suitable form of be is added.
3. The verb is changed into its past participle (v3) form.
4. By is added and the subject in the active voice sentence is mentioned at the end.

Tenses	Active voice	Passive voice
Simple present	Flood causes a lot of damage	**am/are/is+V3 (past participle)** A Lot of damage is caused by floods
Present continuous	The gardener is watering the plants	**am/are/is+being+v3** The plants are being watered by the gardener.
Present perfect	We have organized a special programme for children	**have/has+been+v3** A special programme has been organized for children
Simple past	Raghavendar Rao directed the film Annamaya	**was/were+v3** The film Annamaya was directed by Raghavendra Rao
Past continuous	When they were shifting the patient to the ICU, he died	**Was/were+ being+ v3** When the patient was being shifted to the ICU, he died.
Past perfect	The driver had already alerted the passengers before the robbers entered the bus	**Had+been +v3** The passengers had already been alerted before the robbers entered the bus

Simple future	I will conduct a test tomorrow	**shall/will+be+v3** A test will be conducted tomorrow
Future perfect	They will have decorated the hall by tomorrow	**shall/will+have+been+v3** The hall will have been decorated by evening
Future of intention	Keeravani is going to compose music for this song	**Is going to be+v3** Music is going to be composed by Keeravani for this song
Imperative	Check the spelling	**Let… be+v3** Let the spelling be checked
Interrogative (yes/no)	Do you spell the word correctly?	Is the word spelled correctly?
Interrogative (wh-words)	Why have you sent it through courier?	Why has it been sent it through courier?

Note

Present perfect continuous, past perfect continuous, future perfect continuous and future continuous are not used in the passive voice.

Root words, prefix and suffix

Word roots, prefixes and suffixes

A root is a simple form of a word or a part of a word, without any prefix or suffix. A prefix is a word fragment added in front of a word (e.g, bi-,pre-, un-). A suffix is a word fragment added at the end of a word(e.g, -hood,-less,-y).

Prefix Word	Meanings	Prefix Examples
auto	self	auto-dial, auto-rotate
anti	Instead, against	Antisocial, antacid
A	not , without	Amoral, apolitical
mis	Incorrect, wrongly	Mistake, misspell
pseudo	false	pseudo-science
semi	half	semicircle

Suffix	meaning	examples
cracy	government	Aristocracy, democracy
genic	suitable	Carcinogenic, photogenic
logy	Science of, study of	Biology, geology
en	To become, cause to be	Darken, weaken
hood	Quality, state	Childhood, priesthood
tion	State of something	Elation, depression

Exercises

Identify the root word along with its prefix and suffix:

1. Removed
2. Overlooking
3. Unbelievable
4. Informally

Fill in the blanks

1. Don't be _____ (child+suffix)
2. He ____ his strength (prefix + estimated
3. Our team won the hockey ____ (champion + suffix)

Synonyms and Antonyms

What is a Synonym?

A synonym is a word/phrase, the meaning of which is the same or nearly the same as another word or phrase. Words that are synonyms are described as synonymous.

Synonym examples:

- Artful – Crafty
- Ballot – Poll
- Chorus – Refrain
- Deceptive – Misleading
- Enormous – Immense

What is an Antonym?

An antonym is a word/phrase that means the opposite of another word or phrase. Check the examples.

Antonym examples:

- Admire – Detest
- Bravery – Cowardice
- Crooked – Straight
- Dainty – Clumsy
- Economise – Waste

Phrasal verbs

Phrasal verbs are verbs that consist of two, or sometimes three words. The first word is a verb and it is followed by an adverb or a preposition or both.

Examples:

- **Look after** – To take care of someone or something.
  She looks after her younger brother while their parents are at work.
- **Look for** – To search for something.
  I've been looking for my keys all morning but can't find them.
- **Look forward to** – To anticipate or eagerly await something.
  I'm really looking forward to the weekend getaway.
- **Look into** – To investigate or examine something.
  The manager promised to look into the issue and get back to us.
- **Look out** – To be cautious or watchful.
  Look out for cars when crossing the street!
- **Look up** – To search for information, typically in a reference book or online.
  I'll look up the definition of that word in the dictionary.

Other examples:

Give up – To quit or stop trying (e.g., give up smoking).
Break down – To stop functioning or to collapse (e.g., the car broke down).
Bring up – To raise a topic or subject (e.g., she brought up the issue during the meeting).
Turn up – To arrive or appear (e.g., she turned up late to the party).
Set up – To arrange or organize something (e.g., set up a meeting).

Idioms

Idiom

An **idiom** is a phrase or expression whose meaning is not literally based on the individual words it contains. Instead, its meaning is understood through common use or cultural context. In other words, idioms are expressions where the meaning can't be guessed just by knowing the meaning of each word in the phrase.

Examples include:

- **A piece of cake** – Something that is very easy to do.
  Example: "The exam was a piece of cake."
- **Bite the bullet** – To endure a painful experience or do something unpleasant.
  Example: "I hate going to the dentist, but I'll just have to bite the bullet."
- **Break the ice** – To start a conversation or activity in a social setting, making people feel more comfortable.
  Example: "I told a joke to break the ice at the party."
- **Burn the midnight oil** – To work late into the night.
  Example: "She had to burn the midnight oil to finish the project."
- **Caught between a rock and a hard place** – To be faced with two difficult choices.
  Example: "I'm caught between a rock and a hard place—either I disappoint my friend or miss the deadline."

Oxymoron and Hyperbole

Oxymoron

An oxymoron is a figure of speech where two contradictory or opposite words are placed next to each other to create a special meaning or effect. For example, "bittersweet" combines something that is both bitter and sweet at the same time. It often highlights a contrast or expresses complex feelings in a more effective way.

Some more examples:

- **Deafening silence** – Silence is typically quiet, but here it's described as "deafening," which implies loudness.
- **Living dead** – Refers to beings like zombies, which are neither fully alive nor dead.
- **Act naturally** – "Act" suggests doing something intentionally, but "naturally" suggests doing something without effort.
- **Old news** – Refers to something that is no longer new, but it’s phrased as though it could still be news.
- **Exact estimate** – An estimate that is precise, which contradicts the idea of estimating.

Hyperbole

A **hyperbole** is a figure of speech that involves exaggeration for emphasis or effect. It's not meant to be taken literally, but rather to highlight a particular point, feeling, or idea in an exaggerated way.

Some examples:

- **I'm so hungry I could eat a horse.** – Obviously, someone can't eat a whole horse, but it emphasizes how very hungry they are.
- **I've told you a million times.** – An exaggeration to show how many times something has been repeated.
- **This book weighs a ton.** – It's used to emphasize that the book feels very heavy.
- **He's older than the hills.** – An exaggerated way of saying someone is very old.
- **I'm drowning in homework.** – It means there's a lot of homework, not that the person is literally drowning.
- **It was so cold, I saw polar bears wearing jackets.** – An exaggeration of how cold it was.

Simile and Metaphor

Simile

A **simile** is a figure of speech that makes a comparison between two different things using the words "like" or "as." It’s a way to describe something by highlighting its similarities to something else, often making the description more vivid and expressive.

Some examples include:

- **As brave as a lion** – Comparing someone's courage to that of a lion.
- **As fast as a cheetah** – Describes someone or something very fast, just like a cheetah.
- **She sings like an angel** – Implies that someone has a beautiful or heavenly voice

Metaphor

A **metaphor** is a figure of speech that directly compares two unlike things by stating that one thing **is** the other, without using "like" or "as." It's used to create a deeper or more symbolic meaning.

Examples:

- **Time is a thief** – This suggests that time steals moments from our lives, even though time isn't literally a thief.
- **The world's a stage** – From Shakespeare's *As You Like It*. It compares life to a play, suggesting we all play roles in it.
- **He's a shining star** – Implies that someone is outstanding or exceptional, without saying it literally.
- **Her heart is a cold stone** – Suggests that someone is emotionally distant or unfeeling, without literally meaning their heart is a stone.

Portmanteau words

Portmanteau words

A **portmanteau** is a word that combines parts of two (or more) words to create a new one, typically blending both sounds and meanings. It’s a fun way of merging concepts into a single word.

Some examples include:

- **Brunch** (breakfast + lunch) – A meal that combines elements of both breakfast and lunch.
- **Motel** (motor + hotel) – A hotel designed for people traveling by car.
- **Smog** (smoke + fog) – Air pollution that combines smoke and fog.
- **Blog** (web + log) – A website that contains an individual's or group's written posts.
- **Spork** (spoon + fork) – A utensil that combines both a spoon and a fork.
- **Frenemy** (friend + enemy) – A person who is both a friend and a rival or adversary.
- **Brexit** (Britain + exit) – Refers to the United Kingdom's withdrawal from the European Union.

Collocation

Collocation

Collocation refers to the combination of words that frequently appear together in natural, native-like speech or writing. These word pairs or groups sound correct and are commonly used together, though they might not always be directly related in meaning. Understanding collocations helps improve fluency and makes speech or writing sound more natural.

Natural English	Unnatural English
quick shower	fast shower
strong wind	fast wind
utterly ridiculous	very ridiculous
fully aware	vastly aware
take medicine	drink medicine
catch a cold	receive a cold

One -word substitute

One-word substitutes

One-word substitutes are single words used to replace longer phrases or expressions. These words condense meanings into more concise terms, making language more efficient.

- **Antiquarian** – A person who studies or collects antiques.
- **Bibliophile** – A person who loves or collects books.
- **Polyglot** – A person who knows and is able to use several languages.
- **Philanthropist** – A person who seeks to promote the welfare of others, typically through charitable donations.
- **Unanimous** – Fully in agreement.
  Omnipotent – All-powerful.
- **Aristocrat** – A person of high social rank.
- **Insomniac** – A person who has difficulty sleeping.
- **Misanthrope** – A person who dislikes or hates people.